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The smaller the radius of a liquid drop, the greater is the excess of pressure inside the drop. It is due to this excess of pressure inside, the tiny fog droplets are rigid enough to behave like solids.

When an ice-skater skate over the surface of the ice, some ice melts due to the pressure exerted by the sharp metal edges of the skates, the tiny droplets of water act as rigid ball- bearings and help the skaters to run along smoothly.

EXAMPLE 7.11

If excess pressure is balanced by a column of oil (with specific gravity 0.8) 4 *mm* high, where R = 2.0 *cm*, find the surface tension of the soap bubble.

Solution

The excess of pressure inside the soap bubble is $\Delta P = P_2 - P_1 = \frac{4T}{R}$

But $\Delta P = P_2 - P_1 = \rho gh \Rightarrow \rho gh = \frac{4T}{R}$

$\Rightarrow$ Surface tension,

$$T = \frac{\rho ghR}{4} = \frac{(800)(9.8)(4\times10^{-3})(2\times10^{-2})}{4} =$$

$$T = 15.68\times10^{-2}\, N\, m^{-1}$$

7.5.6 Capillarity

The word 'capilla' means hair in Latin. If the tubes were hair thin, then the rise would be very large. It means that the tube having a very small diameter is called a 'capillary tube'. When a glass capillary tube open at both ends is dipped vertically in water, the water in the tube will rise above the level of water in the vessel. In case of mercury, the liquid is depressed in the tube below the level of mercury in the vessel (shown in Figure 7.29). In a liquid whose angle of contact with solid is less than 90°, suffers capillary rise. On the other hand, in a liquid whose angle of contact is greater than 90°, suffers capillary fall (Table 7.4). The rise or fall of a liquid in a narrow tube is called capillarity or capillary action. Depending on the diameter of the capillary tube, liquid rises or falls to different heights.

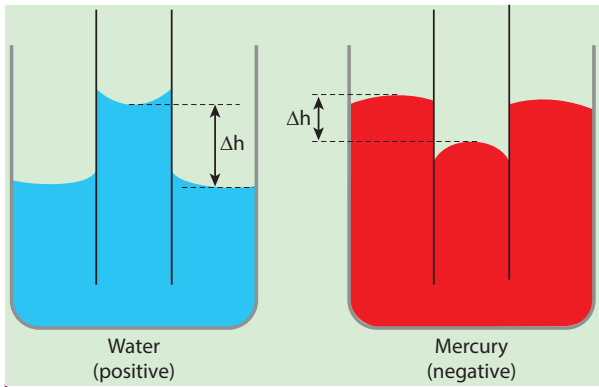


Figure 7.29 Capillary rise or fall

Table 7.4 Capillary rise and fall

Contact angle	Strength of		Degree of wetting	Miniscus	Rise or fall of liquid in the capillary tube
	Cohesive force	Adhesive force			
θ=0 (A)	Weak	Strong	Perfect Wetting	Plane	Neither rises nor is depressed
θ<90 (B)	Weak	Strong	High	Concave	Rise of liquid
θ>90 (C)	Strong	Weak	Low	Convex	Fall of liquid